

Faith for Your Stewardship

While I was praying, the Lord began to run this message through me. I have prayed so long to be an extension of the Holy Ghost, that is, to obey Him.

I have found out that sometimes I am not very popular when I ride something into the ground, teach it to death, and then change and teach something else to death. But I know faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God. I know that when the Holy Ghost tells me to move on, there is no use moving on until the knowledge to activate what we are teaching is present in your life.

If you choose not to activate it, that is up to you. But to fail to communicate it is up to me.

He began to pour a message through me called "Get a Job, Lazy Man." Generally I will major on the problem for a long time, but we did not stay very long on the negative side. It is hard to solve a problem unless you analyze the problem, because then you can understand the solution.

We were preaching on what a busybody is, a person who goes around eating other people's bread for nothing, not working at all. Paul said they ate other people's bread for naught. That is a welfare spirit. It says, "Not only do I want a free ride, but you owe me a free ride."

There is no such thing as a free ride. Whenever anyone lies down, somebody else carries him. You may not carry him directly in your family, but your taxes carry everybody who lies down. If you are looking for a free ride, you are hitchhiking. Somebody stronger than you is carrying you.

God hates that so much that He says if a man will not work, he should not eat. Not eating is a powerful motivator.

This welfare spirit is probably stronger in this generation because the revival of drugs is coming to fruition. I am amazed when I see the culture coming up in our youth now. I was young too, so no one can tell me they have it the same as I had it. They do not.

The devil never intends to leave one generation in better shape than the last if he is in destruction mode and people are walking with him. Each generation will be a little more destroyed than the one before.

It has taken two hundred years of decay to get what the enemy has now pushed into legislation, where sinners dictate morality pertaining to abortion and homosexuality. Our founding forefathers would have rejected that kind of thing because they came here seeking freedom as one nation under God.

The devil finally came up with a chemical revival that imitates the spiritual world. When drug culture came to India, some of the priests in those temples had spent years meditating to attain certain spiritual states. These kids came with hallucinogenic drugs, and with one hit they seemed to get what those priests had tried to reach through years of meditation.

This revival is not good. If we do not have a revival that instantly delivers these young people from these spirits, and not only delivers them but brings restitution so God gives their minds back, this nation is in trouble.

You have thirty- and forty-year-old people still living with their parents. Their bodies are adult, but they do not have the emotional stability to stop, hold down a job, and carry responsibility. We need revival.

God takes a dim view of anybody lying down while somebody else carries him.

We did not stay on the negative side long, because God has made so much available to the person who knows how to throw the bucket into the well and draw the counsel out. He has made so much available to anyone who dares challenge the system as it is.

Ecclesiastes says that to the sinner God gives travail to gather and heap up treasure, but to the man who is good in His sight, He gives wisdom, knowledge, and joy. Those three forces work together. Wisdom employs knowledge, and joy sustains you through tribulation while wisdom and knowledge make the transfer from the sinner who gathered it to the one who is good in God's sight.

You have no idea what God has made available to a person who dares to challenge the system and refuses to let it beat him.

Even though the offices and callings are listed in divine order, God is not saying one calling or gift is better than another. He is showing the order in which they come into existence and how one is necessary to birth the next.

God placed first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that workings of miracles, gifts of healings, helps, governments, and diversities of tongues. Without evangelists there would be nobody speaking with tongues. He lists them in divine order, not because one is better than another.

Workings of miracles and gifts of healings envelop the pastoral and evangelistic offices, along with teacher, apostle, and prophet. Those gifts are supposed to empower ministry with the infallible presence of God, even in a Sunday morning service.

Then come helps and governments. A person may say that workings of miracles and gifts of healings are better than teaching or governmental gifts, but they are not.

The fivefold ministry, in one form or another, is called to handle the Word. It may be mobile or local. It may teach, evangelize, travel, apostolically build, or prophesy. But helps and governments are the organizational gifts that organize everything around those who handle the Word.

Some ministers cannot seem to tie their shoes, but when they walk out and pick up a microphone, it is over. Helps and governments make that possible.

Let me talk to you about prosperity. I can hardly wait for the day when five hundred thousand Japanese are swept into the kingdom. I cannot wait for the day when I sweep my first million into the kingdom, preferably in America, in one meeting.

We will see it. If you hang around, we will see things around here as a body. But if you think we are ever going to quit pressing prayer, you might as well find another place now, because we never will. I know the basis for all spiritual stability is a personal prayer life with the Father.

I cannot imagine how I will feel when we sweep our first million in through evangelism, or when five hundred thousand Japanese are born again out of that nation as God pours out revival fire. This is my whole life.

My call is to handle the Word part of that. I get to stand up and let Him cut away resistance with the two-edged sword until the crowd begins moving forward in miracles, healings, and salvations.

But what makes you think that as a businessman enveloped in helps and governments, not called to handle the Word like I do, your calling is any less? It is not. One office makes another work. The one that serves another is not subordinate or less. The arm does not work well without the hand, and you cannot brag on the hand without bragging on the arm.

To see a million people born again would be my cup of tea. But as a businessman in helps and governments, how would you feel if you wrote the million-dollar check that made it possible? How would you feel knowing that the wisdom God employed in you, as you administered in helps and governments and in your business, transferred wealth from the sinner's hand to yours through wisdom, knowledge, and joy, and you did it legally?

The Holy Ghost comes on me and five people get out of wheelchairs. He comes on you and you clear seven hundred thousand dollars. Do you think there is any difference? When both gifts are finished, the fruit will be the same.

I said that to get to this point: what would make you think your prayer time is any less important than mine?

Many businessmen do not lose their fortunes to the world; they lose them to God. Because of lack of prayer, when they attain their fortune, God no longer has it. It no longer benefits the kingdom.

If you do not think your prayer time is as important as mine, you are wrong.

If a million people are born again, the devil is not going to let me exist comfortably on the earth. Paul said that because of the abundance of his revelations, a messenger of Satan was assigned to buffet him. Three times he sought God's grace because he did not think he could stand up under it, and God showed him how worship played into it, how to switch dependency from the flesh to the spirit.

Paul was setting the foundation for the whole early church, and the devil hated every grain of sand he walked on. Do you think the devil would let me comfortably sweep a hundred thousand people into the kingdom a day? If the Bible is a lie, maybe. But it is not.

If you are going to pay the million dollars that sweeps a million into the kingdom, the devil will be just as angry at you as he is at me. If you are going to operate in workings of miracles in the business place and sow that money into the kingdom, your prayer time is as important to you as mine is to me.

If I do not stay in tune with God, eventually I could fall prey like other men of God have fallen prey. If I fall out of prayer, the enemy will eventually hedge a fence around me, fight my carnality, corral my gift, and discredit me somewhere. If I stay in prayer, it is not likely to happen.

If you think you can put millions into the kingdom without a relationship with God, he will corral your carnality the same way. Pretty soon the kingdom will get less and less of your money. The devil does not care how much you have, as long as the kingdom does not have it.

Let us understand what Jesus is saying in Luke 17:5-6:

And the apostles said unto the Lord, Increase our faith.

And the Lord said, If ye had faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye might say unto this sycamine tree, Be thou plucked up by the root, and be thou planted in the sea; and it should obey you.

You have to understand that Jesus was teaching on the stewardship of money. He began in Luke 15 with the prodigal son who squandered his inheritance, continued through Luke 16 with the unjust steward and the rich man and Lazarus, and kept teaching until the apostles finally could not take any more and cried, "Increase our faith."

The faith they were asking for was faith for stewardship on this earth.

If we can understand what Jesus said in light of the entire teaching, then we can understand the kind of faith it takes to walk in stewardship. The apostles were asking Jesus how a person's faith increases for stewardship. His answer contains enough information to settle the issue.

I knew that if I could get into that chapter and understand what He was saying, He would eradicate my sense of lack. He has done that about ninety percent.

Even when this church had large quarterly payments, I never came out and put pressure on you. Why put pressure on the sheep? I put the pressure where it belonged. I slept well the weekend before payments were due because part of what eradicated my sense of lack was camping in that chapter until faith came.

No prosperity teacher I know can teach as well as Jesus. If He is going to settle the issue for me once and for all, I want to know what He said about it. I pitched a tent in that chapter and camped on it until enough faith was born in my spirit to remove enough care that Satan could not devour me on the level where he had been devouring me.

First Peter 5 tells us to cast the whole of our care on Him because He cares for us, and then it says our adversary the devil walks about as a roaring lion seeking whom he may devour. Those verses are in succession.

The reason He tells you to get rid of care is that care is what the devil seeks out in your life. He seeks people full of worry, torment, and care because that is what makes them devourable.

If care is what makes me devourable, then the highest form of resisting the devil is getting rid of the care. You need to take the necessary steps to learn how to roll the whole of your care over on Him and leave it there.

That is not an act of mental attitude. It is a work of the Spirit.

I appreciate teachers who taught the principle by holding up keys and saying, "These keys are your cares. Give them to God." The principle is true. The cares still exist, but they are not yours anymore.

But I found out it is not merely mental. I rolled them over on Him many times, but my cares drove faster than I did. By the time I got home and opened the mail, they had beaten me there.

It was not until learning to pray in tongues extensively, according to Isaiah 28, "This is the rest, and this is the refreshing," that the birthing of mysteries opened the content of these chapters and supplied the faith to put me into a place where most of the time care cannot devour me.

Once in a while the enemy still tries to invade, and I may wobble for a day or two. But since I know what to do, I get my feet back on the rock before destruction is done.

The Lord trained me for years to come to this place where He would ask me to settle down in Tulsa with a group of people, find out what stands between us and the revival of lost men by His power, and punch through to receive it.

I thought I had enough training. Then we hit the first barrier, and I realized how much I still needed to learn. But I am going to complete the course He set me on.

If you are going to have millions for the kingdom, never underestimate the importance of prayer. By the time you get there, either the money will own you and the kingdom will not benefit, or the enemy will cancel your money out. But if you walk with God, He will deliver that anointing to you as surely as He will deliver a miracle-working anointing to empty wheelchairs and sweep multitudes into the kingdom.

By the time Jesus wound this message up, after the rich man and Lazarus, the unjust steward, the Pharisees being exposed for covetousness, and all His teaching on finances, the apostles cried, "Increase our faith."

In the verses that followed was the key. If you understand them and get them into your spirit, they will eradicate your sense of lack and deliver you to the peace that spells prosperity.

Paul says we came into this world naked and will leave the same way. Those who seek to be rich fall into many temptations and hurts. If we have food and clothing, we are to be content. He was not saying you will never become wealthy for the kingdom's sake. He was saying that if you seek

contentment in God, then God can ask you to give three million tomorrow and you can do it, still having your contentment. Then through wisdom and knowledge He can transfer ten million out of the sinner's hands for next year in the kingdom.

That anointing is as available and as needed as the anointing on the man standing on the front line calling people to Jesus.

To understand Luke 17, we have to back up to Luke 16:8-9:

And the lord commended the unjust steward, because he had done wisely:
For the children of this world are in their generation wiser than the children of light.

That is embarrassing. Jesus differentiated between the children of darkness and the children of light by saying that the children of this world were wiser in handling money for their needs and causes.

Then He gives us instruction that will make us wiser than the sinner ever dreamed:

Make to yourselves friends of the mammon of unrighteousness; that, when ye fail, they may receive you into everlasting habitations.

The unjust steward used the power of attorney in the name of his rich man to cancel the debts owed to his master so that later he could move into their houses. Jesus is saying to us: use the power in money to cancel people's debts against God, the sin question. Every person born again because of that use of temporary money will receive you into an everlasting habitation when your life over temporary finances is over.

If you use temporary money to sweep people into the kingdom, He is willing to give you more wisdom than the sinner ever dreamed of having.

Jesus also said:

No servant can serve two masters...
Ye cannot serve God and mammon.

When the apostles said, "Increase our faith," this was all heading toward His explanation of how faith increases to be a steward in the kingdom of God.

The sinner's master is mammon. When Christian businessmen sit at council tables with sharks, do they think those men intend to let them negotiate the best deal?

Many Christian businessmen testify, "I am going to get rich for the kingdom's sake." They want God's counsel and wisdom, but sometimes instead of using wisdom, they try to substitute presumption for faith. They run out on a limb, buy a bunch of junk, and their eyes are full of dollar

signs. They think they will get by with it because, "God knows that when I make a million off this deal, He will get His share."

You can psych yourself and other people and use the kingdom as a cover for dollar signs, but God knows.

That is what Jesus told the Pharisees: "God knows your heart, and what is highly esteemed among men is an abomination in the sight of God."

The reason many Christian businessmen are defeated is that their God is not as much God to them as the sinner's god is to the sinner. They try to replace sloppy, bad business decisions with claims that they are doing it for God.

If you are as diligent to serve God as they are to serve mammon, you will get up and pray. While they are making business decisions and going over papers hour after hour, you will be walking the floor in a language of edification, with worship and the Word setting the standard for that business deal. Mostly, this is for the transformation of your own character, so God will be so much your God that you can sit down with the sharks and out-negotiate them through wisdom, knowledge, and joy.

They will heap it up, and you will come in and take it away for the kingdom.

After Jesus says that faith as a grain of mustard seed can command the sycamine tree and it will obey, He asks a question:

But which of you, having a servant plowing or feeding cattle, will say unto him by and by, when he is come from the field, Go and sit down to meat?

And will not rather say unto him, Make ready wherewith I may sup, and gird thyself, and serve me... and afterward thou shalt eat and drink?

Doth he thank that servant because he did the things that were commanded him? I trow not.

Questions are valuable teaching tools. Jesus used them all the time. When someone asks a question, you have to put a demand on the knowledge you are presently walking in to answer it.

The apostles knew what servants were. Matthew was a tax collector, Luke was a physician, and Peter owned a fishing business. Jesus said, "Which of you having a servant, when he comes in from the field after plowing or feeding cattle, would say, 'Go sit down and eat first, then come serve me when you are done'?"

They all knew the answer. No master would do that. The master would say, "Prepare my meal. Gird yourself and serve me until I have eaten and drunk. Afterward you can eat and drink."

Does he thank the servant because he did what was commanded? No. A top-notch servant is supposed to make sure all the needs of his master are met first, and then he can sit down and eat from the master's table.

Then Jesus switched the roles:

So likewise ye, when ye shall have done all those things which are commanded you, say, We are unprofitable servants:

We have done that which was our duty to do.

They asked for an increase of faith for stewardship, and Jesus put them in the servant's role.

"Unprofitable" here does not mean "my righteousness is as filthy rags." It means these servants were not serving the kingdom for gain.

If all you are looking at God for is an avenue of prosperity, you have Him all wrong. He is first your Prince of Peace and your everlasting supply in a time of trouble. When there is no food and your dollar is not worth the paper it is printed on, God still says not to take thought for what you will eat, drink, or wear. He knows you need these things.

Jesus asks, "What do you want the increase of faith for? To build your own kingdom, or to serve the needs of the kingdom?"

You are the servant. The Master is the Lord Jesus Christ. When the priority of your heart is to serve the kingdom and make sure the needs of the kingdom are met, then you are a steward. If you want to use your faith to increase the kingdom, that is the key that causes increase.

In your finances, there is no other key.

If you are going to swim with sharks, if your wisdom is going to be greater than a man whose whole god is mammon, you had better make sure your God is really God to you. You had better take on a servant's heart, because Jesus will know whether you have one.

That is the key to His prosperity.